TA studio brief — Recording an exhibition: three visual moments

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 6 Part 1 · Big question: How do we capture rapid observational sketches, spatial notes, and lighting analyses from curated artworks?

TA practical setup & focus

Set up three clear 'Exhibition stations' around the room featuring mounted relief and identity exemplars lit by angled desk lamps so pupils have authentic gallery stations to sketch.

Studio kit: Week 5 prepared Gallery inquiry sheets on clipboards, curated exhibition stations (mounted relief/identity works + directional lamps), 2B/4B/6B graphite, fineliners

Key words to prompt

• field sketch: A rapid, observant drawing made directly in front of an artwork to capture structure, light, and mark-making.

• visual moment: A specific focal aspect of an exhibition (how a piece is lit, how two works contrast, or how a joint is made).

• shorthand mark: Fast, expressive hatching or stippling that records surface texture in seconds.

• curatorial framing: How plinths, borders, lighting angles, and wall space direct the viewer's response.

• primary evidence: Your own first-hand sketches and observational notes recorded directly from the artworks.

Supported route steps

1. At station 1, sketch the main frame shape and draw an arrow showing where the lamp shines from.

2. At station 2, shade the dark, mid, and light areas into your tonal thumbnail box.

3. At station 3, copy one close-up texture pattern into your close-up box.

4. Tick and complete the three observation notes on your clipboard sheet.

Check: Three station sketches (space, tone, texture) and observation notes completed on clipboard.

Review & exit support

Exit question: When making a timed field sketch of a textured artwork in an exhibition, how do you record complex surface grain efficiently?

Staff note: Staff preparation only: review how to set up classroom gallery stations with directional lamps for live 6-minute field sketching.